ÓGHOWA BUSINESS WEEK

Theme: "Innovation for Economic Transformation"

PROBLEM STATEMENT

There is one prevailing challenge in our business ecosystem; Inability to work together to transform Edo state. Despite the growing number of entrepreneurs, SMEs, innovators, and research institutions in Edo State, collaboration between business, government, academia, investors, and development partners remains fragmented. This has limited access to finance, technology, strategic partnerships, markets, and policies needed to transform innovative ideas into sustainable businesses and economic opportunities.

In today's global economy, businesses are increasingly driven by innovation and technology, thereby, there's an urgent need for a platform that convenes key stakeholders to foster collaboration, promote investment, encourage digital transformation, and accelerate business growth.

> **Welcome to: Oghowa Business Week**, under the theme **"Innovation for Economic Transformation,"** we address this need by providing a flagship platform that connects ideas with investment, innovation with enterprise, and partnerships with measurable economic impact, positioning Edo State as a leading hub for business and innovation.

WHAT'S OUR VISION STATEMENT

Oghowa Business Week is an annual platform that brings together entrepreneurs, businesses, investors, policymakers, researchers, development partners, and innovators to accelerate economic transformation through innovation, technology, entrepreneurship, strategic partnerships, and investment.

WHY US?

1. **Institutional Alignment & Policy Activation**
   To serve as the primary sub-national platform that bridges state regulatory frameworks (like MDEST and ICTA) with active private-sector innovations, turning public policy into executable business advantages.

2. **Capital Mobilization for the Local Frontier**
   To de-risk the Edo tech ecosystem by bringing public intervention funds (like BOI's iDICE framework) and private venture capital directly to Benin City, establishing formal funding pipelines for early-stage founders.
3. **Integration of the Real Sector & Remote Economy**
   To drive true economic transformation by matching digital solutions with brick-and-mortar industries (AgriTech and Logistics) while formalizing global outsourcing tracks (such as AI data annotation and digital media) for local talents.

WHAT WE WANT TO ACHIEVE

To track success dynamically, you can break your goals down across the ecosystem stakeholders:

For Government & Financial Institutions

- **Secure Financial Commitments:** Onboard at least 3 tier-1 institutional partners (e.g., Bank of Industry, Ministry of Trade, and commercial bank SME divisions) to clarify and open application access lines directly for the ecosystem during the week.
- **Policy Simplification:** Deliver 1 clear, actionable feedback brief from local founders directly to the Ministry of Digital Economy (MDEST) regarding local cloud procurement and startup incentives.

For Founders & Private Investors

- **Capital Pipeline Velocity:** Pre-vet and showcase at least 8 to 10 high-traction startup cohorts on Demo Day to a panel of visiting angel investors and venture capitalists.
- **Corporate Readiness:** Transition at least 20 early-stage ventures through the Day 2 Corporate Governance and legal compliance clinics, ensuring they leave with clean regulatory foundations.

For Developers & Digital Talents

- **Talent Placement:** Facilitate real-world workspace integration by connecting at least 50 skilled engineers, data specialists, and product managers directly to hiring founders or global remote outsourcing networks during the Day 5 Talent Expo.
- **Rapid Prototyping Output:** Produce at least 4 working developer prototypes during the 24-hour Hackathon sprint that directly address localized bottlenecks in regional logistics or commodity distribution.

EVENT SCHEDULE & PROGRAM ARCHITECTURE

MONDAY, 16 NOVEMBER 2026

Day 1: The Macro-Economy, Commerce & Policy Forum

"Setting the Framework for Sub-National Growth"

This day brings out high-level policy enablers, regulatory heads, and major financial institutions to set the state's economic and trade agenda.

09:00 AM – 10:15 AM	**Grand Opening Ceremony** Welcome Address by the Organizers (Metaspace / Óghowa Team). Executive Keynote by the Edo State Government (The Executive Office / ESIPO) on the sub-national roadmap for economic stability.
10:30 AM – 12:00 PM	**Part 1: The High-Level Trade & Commerce Panel** The Ministry of Trade, Industry and Commerce alongside Commercial Bank Directors address regulatory updates, automating trade registries, ease of doing business, and credit lines for formalized regional MSMEs.
12:15 PM – 01:45 PM	**Part 2: The Bank of Industry & Development Finance Masterclass** The Bank of Industry (BOI) details its operational intervention programs (including tech/creative initiatives like the iDICE fund framework), clarifying the exact compliance and governance checklist required for local ventures to access long-term capital.
01:45 PM – 03:00 PM	**Networking Lunch**

TUESDAY, 17 NOVEMBER 2026

Day 2: Digital Infrastructure, Tech Policy & The Founder’s Blueprint

Morning Forum: The Digital Infrastructure & Tech Policy Forum

"Governing the Stack and Deploying Local Clouds"

This brings in the technical arms of the government to interact with developers, data experts, and system architects regarding data security and networks.

08:30 AM – 10:00 AM	**Part 1: The Tech Stack & Local Sovereignty Panel** The Information and Communication Technology Agency (ICTA) outlines modern sub-national cloud deployments (like the Edo Cloud homegrown e-governance infrastructure), public infrastructure access, and local software procurement rules.
10:15 AM – 11:45 AM	**Part 2: Digital Economy Policy & Ecosystem Grants** The Ministry of Digital Economy, Science and Technology (MDEST) unpacks the state's overarching data management policies, digital security frameworks, and multi-sector intervention programs (such as the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation-backed Strengthening Edo State’s Digital Solutions Ecosystem initiative).
11:45 AM – 12:45 PM	**Open Networking Floor**

Afternoon Track: The Founder’s Blueprint & Real-Sector Integration

"From Ideation to Market-Ready Corporate Assets"

A deep dive into operational mechanics, shifting into how software and platforms directly integrate with Edo’s real-world brick-and-mortar logistics and commodities trading.

12:45 PM – 02:45 PM	**Masterclass: Product-Market Fit (PMF) & System Architecture** Engineering scalable multi-tenant architectures, digital service workflows, and localized user onboarding strategies designed specifically for West African tech ecosystems (EdTech, Logistics, Fintech).
03:00 PM – 04:45 PM	**Clinic: Corporate Governance & Legal Compliance** Structuring IP assignment, drafting ironclad NDAs, implementing clean financial tracking systems, and setting up founding teams to survive investor due diligence.
05:00 PM – 07:00 PM	**Panel Focus: Tech in the Trenches — AgriTech, Logistics & Commodity Trade** Bridging code with distribution: Local agro-processors, oil palm ecosystem players, and transport networks debate with tech founders on how to digitize supply chains, leverage data frameworks, and onboard local traders into automated market systems.

THURSDAY, 19 NOVEMBER 2026

Day 3: Venture Capital & Private Equity Day

"Unlocking Private Runway and Global Networks"

Shifting the focus from public institutional funding to private markets, angel networks, and venture capital syndicates.

10:00 AM – 11:30 AM	**Investor Panel: What Venture Capital Looks For** Venture capitalists, angel syndicates, and seed-stage fund managers discuss metric expectations, evaluating tech talent, risk mitigation, and how they view sub-national markets.
11:45 AM – 01:15 PM	**Workshop: Deconstructing the Term Sheet** A practical workshop teaching tech founders how to navigate valuation, cap-table dilution, investor clauses, and board seats without losing corporate control.
02:30 PM – 04:00 PM	**Closed Reverse Pitching Session** Visiting fund managers and ecosystem builders present their investment focus, sectors of interest, and ticket sizes directly to the general hub audience.

SATURDAY, 21 NOVEMBER 2026

Day 4: Grand Finale & Demo Day

"Showcasing Ecosystem Transformation"

The high-stakes culmination of the business week, celebrating tech landmarks and pitching verified local models to the market.

10:00 AM – 11:30 AM	**Ecosystem Keynote: The 2030+ Operational Outlook** A closing presentation mapping regional expansion goals, scalability milestones, student mobility frameworks, and the compounding growth of technology clusters in Edo.
11:45 AM – 02:00 PM	**The Main Event: The Óghowa Demo Day** Pre-vetted, high-traction startup cohorts pitch their working software models and business pipelines live on stage to our assembled panel of banks, institutional VCs, and angel networks.
02:00 PM – 03:30 PM	**Closing Ceremony & Ecosystem Awards** Presentation of startup grant acknowledgments, hackathon/innovation awards, and recognition of corporate, ministerial, and banking partners.